



r/airbnb_hosts • 10mo ago

hold_my_brew



Schlage lock draining quickly

Hi guys! Somewhat new to hosting here. I have a Schlage lock installed and the battery has been pretty consistently draining up until this point. I have a guest staying until Sunday. From last night to today the battery has drained from 34% to 26%. Do you guys advise that I bother the guest to stop by and replace the battery or give them the lockbox code or neither? I've read Schlage is notorious for crapping the bed when it gets low. We're using normal batteries. Thanks so much!



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MOD • 10mo ago • Sticked comment



DavePastry • 10mo ago



Verified

I have 16 encode locks for all the properties I manage, the battery levels can drop weirdly like that, you'll probably be fine until sunday but replacing them would be the safe bet, if you dont already put a spare key in a combo lockbox somewhere guests could get to on the outside of the property, they are generally very reliable but you need a fail safe just in case with them.



hold_my_brew OP • 10mo ago

Thanks for the advice. My only fear is that it looks bad on me if I wasn't "prepared" and need to stop by the house to bother them which would lead to a bad review.



Verified

it really shouldn't be a big deal, and them being locked out in the middle of the night with a dead lock would lead to a much worse review anyway.

I would just message them casually and say hey the battery to the door lock is a little low, is there a good time for me to swing by and swap that out? it will only take 30 seconds and if you're not home I can just crack the door to get it done. done it plenty of times, never had a guest have a problem with it, if they really dont want you to for some reason and the lock fails, that's what the lockbox spare is for. Also, you'll almost certainly be fine until sunday, 25% is usually enough for at least a couple weeks of normal use.

also if it continues vexing you, the lever version of the encodes last significantly longer than the deadbolt models, like 3 or 4 times longer.

**cestquitonpere** • 10mo ago

Smart idea. I'll get myself a lock box as backup in case the unit dies while we are away. Thanks for sharing

**[deleted]** • 9mo ago**Best_Day_3041** • 9mo ago

Unverified

First off make sure you use a high capacity battery like the Energizer Ultimate Lithium. Next make sure the lock has a strong WIFI connection, if it's weak the lock will consume more batteries.

**gritsource** • 9mo ago

This.

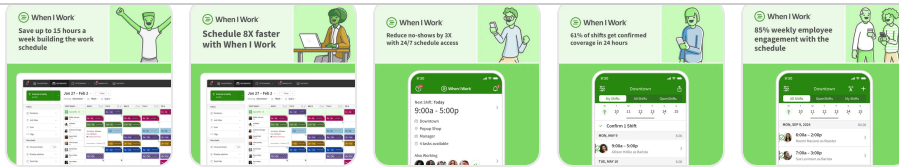
**AustEastTX** • 10mo ago

Verified (Austin, TX)

One of 2 of my Schlage encodes drains faster than the other at a rate of 1:2 I don't know why. Could be heat/cold on the battery. The one that drains is in direct sun whilst the other is on my front patio and therefore shaded. 🙄

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**New_Taste8874** • 10mo ago

Host

Get the regular Schlage electronic locks. I have 9 of them and have not changed batteries since I bought them 6 years ago.

**KyleAltNJRealtor** • 9mo ago

That's because they're performing way less work. Connectivity is important to a lot of hosts.



+ [deleted] • 9mo ago

**Square-Ask-9836** • 10mo ago

We have these in our primary house and it does drain the batteries. Our whole street has the same builder house with the same locks and it seems like the homes that don't get direct sunlight and heat the batteries drain less. Don't know if it's related, but I especially didn't put this brand in my Airbnb because of the issue at our primary house

**United-Budget8592** • 10mo ago

Unverified

Mine is similar. Drains pretty linear till about 40 or 50% then kind of accelerates till it's dead. I had a scare it was going to go out on a guest too so I just started switching the batteries when I notice they're under 50%. A few bucks extra in batteries every year isn't worth the stress

**KyleAltNJRealtor** • 9mo ago

I've had the same issue in the past as well. Not sure if it's in my head but I did a factory reset on the one that was draining and it seems to have fixed.

It's weird with the Encodes. I have 13 of them, and they all kind of behave a little differently.



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SurprisedWildebeest • 9mo ago

Host

I would keep an eye on it until tonight. If it's still draining quickly, let the guest know you got a low battery alert for the door lock and ask if it's ok to stop by and change them real quick. I change mine at 50% and do not use rechargeables. (I use up the rest in remotes.)



LifeLearner1583 • 9mo ago

I recently had a locksmith drill out the core of my smart lock (dead battery and no key), he said there is a new lock with battery ports, and if the batteries in your lock die, you can hold a 9v battery against the ports and get enough juice to open the lock. Not good for a renter, but if it's your own locked cupboard/door, it's a cheaper fix.



hs19901 • 9mo ago

Our Yale assure lock does the same thing. We typically wait until the guest is out and about and quickly swap the batteries. But wondering if anyone has tricks to help them last longer? We need the WiFi (rather than just Bluetooth) to help sync the lock so we can't turn that off.